PimEyes

A PARENT'S GUIDE

What you need to know. What to watch for. What to do.

PimEyes is a facial recognition search engine. It lets anyone upload a photo and search the internet to find other images of the same face. It can be useful, but it also comes with serious privacy and safety risks.

This guide helps you keep your child safe, informed and in control.

CYBER SAFETY GUY

1 IN 4

16–24 year olds in the UK say they have used AI tools for companionship or emotional support.

Source: Ofcom, Children and Parents: Media Use and Attitudes Report 2024

29%

of 8–17 year olds in the UK said they sometimes feel addicted to the internet.

Source: Ofcom, Children and Parents: Media Use and Attitudes Report 2023

66%

of parents are worried about inappropriate content online.

Source: Ofcom, Children and Parents: Media Use and Attitudes Report 2024

FACIAL IMAGES CAN BE FOUND ONLINE

Once a photo is out there, it can be searched, shared and copied.

1 WHAT IS PIMEYES?



- PimEyes is a facial recognition search engine.
- You upload a photo of a face.
- It scans the internet for matching images.
- It shows where that face appears, even on sites you didn't know about.
- It is used by the public, businesses and in some cases law enforcement.

PARENT NOTE: PimEyes regularly changes features, pricing and policies. Always check the latest information on their website.

2 WHY YOUNG PEOPLE SHOULD CARE

Your child's face can appear online in places they didn't choose or expect: social media, school websites, news articles, forums, gaming profiles, memes and more. PimEyes can find those images.

THIS CAN LEAD TO:

Loss of privacy
People can find images of your child without their consent.

Online tracking
Useful for stalking, harassment or following someone around the web.

Reputation risks
Old or embarrassing photos can be found by future employers, schools or others.

Safety concerns
Predators or scammers can use photos to build a profile.

3 THE RISKS PARENTS SHOULD KNOW

Privacy invasion
Anyone can search for your child's face using just one photo.

Stalking and harassment
Can be used to track, locate or intimidate young people.

Identity misuse
Images can be used for fake profiles, scams or grooming.

No control once it's indexed
Even if you delete a post, the image may still be searchable on PimEyes.

False confidence
Young people may not realise how easy it is to search and find them.

If something feels wrong or unsafe online, talk to a trusted adult. You can always get help. (See bottom of guide.)

4 WHAT PARENTS CAN DO

1. **Talk and educate**
   Explain how facial recognition works and why photos online last.
2. **Review online presence**
   Google your child's name and look for public photos or profiles.
3. **Control what you share**
   Think before posting photos of your child online.
4. **Use privacy settings**
   Lock down social media accounts and remove unnecessary photos.
5. **Teach safe habits**
   Encourage them to be mindful of what they post and where.
6. **Use removal tools**
   PimEyes offers an opt-out/removal form. See Section 7.

5 CONVERSATION STARTERS

- "What kind of photos do you think are safe to post online?"
- "Do you know that people can search for your face online?"
- "How would you feel if someone tracked you online?"
- "What could someone do with your pictures?"
- "What should you do if you see your photos online somewhere you don't like?"

Keep it open, calm and judgement-free. That's how trust grows.

6 HOW TO STAY SAFER ONLINE

Limit what you share
Share less. The less online, the less searchable.

Check tagging and mentions
Review tags on social media and remove ones you don't want.

Use strong privacy settings
Make accounts private and say no to public sharing.

Be aware of screenshots
Images can be saved and shared, even in private chats.

Search yourself
Google your name and use PimEyes to see what's out there (where allowed).

PimEyes effectiveness depends on the image and where it appears. It is not 100% accurate.

7 REMOVING YOUR CHILD'S IMAGES FROM PIMEYES

You can request removal of your child's images.

1. Go to: pimeyes.com/en/privacy
   (Click "Opt-out" or "Remove my photos")
2. Fill in the removal request form with the image URLs shown in the PimEyes results.
3. Submit the request. PimEyes will review it and remove the links from their search results.

Note: Removal from PimEyes does not remove the image from the original website or the rest of the internet.

WHERE TO GET HELP

If you or your child need support, help is available.

Childline: 0800 1111
childline.org.uk

The Mix
0808 808 4994
themix.org.uk

Internet Matters
internetmatters.org
Advice, guides and tools for parents.

REMEMBER

You can't control everything online. But you can stay curious, stay involved and keep the conversation going.

STAY CURIOUS. STAY INVOLVED. KEEP THE CONVERSATION GOING.

YOUR CHILD'S SAFETY STARTS WITH A CHAT.

YOU DON'T NEED ALL THE ANSWERS. YOU JUST NEED TO BE THERE.